

Chapter (11)

Managers and Communication

- The word 'communication' comes from the Latin word communis which means common. This implies that when we communicate, we are trying to establish 'commonality' with someone through a message.
- Communication, then, is a conscious attempt to establish commonality over some idea, fact, feelings and the like, with others. In essence, it is a process of getting a source and a receiver tuned together for a particular message or a series of messages.

Overview

1. Communication is anything that conveys meaning, that carries a message from one person to another.
2. Communication is the mutual interchange of ideas by any effective means.
3. Communication in its simplest form is conveying of information from one person to another.

Definition

1. The information function :It serves to provide knowledge to the individuals who need guidance in their actions. It also fulfils the workers' desires for awareness of things that affect them.
2. The command and instructive function : This function makes the employee aware of his obligations to the formal organization and provides him with additional guidance on how to perform his duties adequately.

Functions of Communication

3. The influence and persuasive function : This function motivates, directs and guides the employees to act and influence the behavior and attitudes of the people through arguments and persuasion.
4. The integrative function : Communication, if properly handled, integrates the activities and efforts of the workers. As a result, they move in a single desired direction and the whole organization becomes a well-knit system

Functions of communication

1. Communication involves plurality of persons.
2. Existence of a message.
3. Communication is a continuous process.
4. Communication is a two way process.
5. Communication is a universal process.
6. Communication is a social process.

**Characteristics/ Nature/ Features
of communication**

7. Communication may be written, oral or gestural.
8. Communication may be formal or informal
9. Communication may be vertical, horizontal or diagonal.
10. Primary purpose is to motivate a response.
11. Communication is unavoidable.

**Characteristics/ Nature/ Features
of communication**

- **Source** :It is the point of origin of the message. The person who starts the process of communication is also called the communicator. The communicator decides what message is to be sent, how to treat it, what channel to use and which receivers to reach.
- **Message** :A message is the information a communicator wishes his audience to receive, understand, accept and act upon. The message may be information, instructions or orders.
- **Channel** :It is anything used by a communicator of messages to connect him with the intended receivers. It may be a letter, meeting, radio, newspaper, television etc through which the communicator reaches the receivers.

Communication process

- **Receivers** :Receivers are the intended audience of messages. They are the consumer of the messages. (By acting on the messages the receiver is likely to gain economically or socially.) The communicator should identify and aim his messages towards his intended audience.
- **Effect** :Effect is the response by the audience to the messages received by them. This may be some kind of mental or physical action. The action should be viewed as a product of the communication process

Communication process

1. Physical and Mechanical Barriers.
2. Language or Semantic Barriers.
3. Socio-Psychological Barriers.
4. Organizational Barriers.
5. Personal Barriers.

Barriers to Communication

- There are some guidelines for choice of content and style of presentation adapted for the purpose by the receiver of the message.
- They are also called “Seven C’s” of effective communication. They are :

Effective Communication

1. **Completeness** – Every communication must be complete in itself. Incomplete messages keep the receiver guessing, create misunderstanding and delay actions. Messages must offer complete and relevant information in order to become effective. Incomplete information makes it necessary to begin another cycle of communication to issue clarification.
2. **Conciseness** – In business communications, you should be brief and be able to say whatever you have to say in fewest possible words without sacrificing the other qualities. A concise message is complete without being wordy.
3. **Correctness** – The term correctness as applied to business messages means right level of language and accuracy of facts, figures and words. If the information is not correctly conveyed, the sender will lose credibility.

"Seven C's" of effective communication

4. **Concreteness** – of message is an essential requirement of effective communication. It means being specific, definite and vivid rather than vague and general. Concrete expressions create visual images that are easy to register. So instead of vague, generalized statements, give definite facts.
5. **Clarity** – The message must be put in simple terms to ensure clarity. Words must mean the same thing to the receiver as they do to the sender. Complex issues must be compressed into themes, slogans or stereotypes that have simplicity and clarity. Your language should consist of simple words and short sentences.

“Seven C’s” of effective communication

- 6. Consideration** – Consideration means preparing the message with the intended receiver in mind. In order to communicate effectively, the sender should think and look from the receiver's angle. He should adopt a humane approach and understand the emotions and sentiments of the receiver.
- 7. Courtesy** – or politeness stems from sincere you-attitude. It is not merely politeness with mechanical insertions of "please" and "thank you", although applying socially accepted manners is a form of courtesy.

"Seven C's" of effective communication

Downward Communication

The flow of information from highest to lowest level in the organizational hierarchy. Managers use it to accomplish a variety of key organizational functions and objectives as follows:

- To clarify and build support for the organization mission.
- To instruct, direct, query or reward employees, • To explain policies, rules, regulations and codes of practices
- To provide feedback from management,
- To share information about the organization's health and about key elements in the external environments.

Types of communication

Upward Communication

On the other hand upward communication is the flow of information from lower to higher levels in the organization.

Managers encourage upward communication to perform the following important functions:

- To gather valuable information,
- To give employees the opportunity to air grievances,
- To find out when employees are ready for information from management,
- To get feedback from the employees in the forms of reports, complaint, suggestions, advice, etc.
- To get information about work problems.

Types of communication